

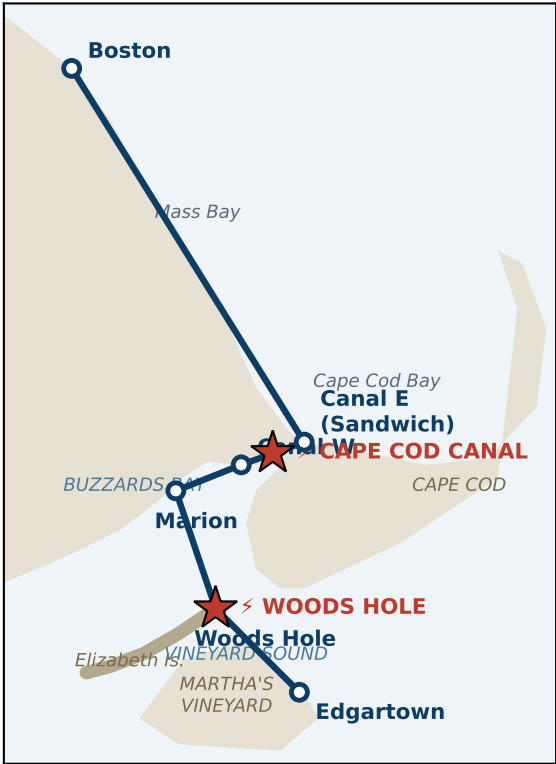
Delivery Plan — Eagle (Najad 380, dual-handed)

Boston → Marion → Edgartown, MA · depart Tue 2026-07-21 08:00 EDT · Leg 1 ~55 nm · Leg 2 ~22 nm · assumed ~6 kt

TWO CURRENT GATES decide this trip — Cape Cod Canal (ride the ebb) + Woods Hole (transit at slack); both run 3-5 kt.

generated 2026-07-21 00:55Z · currents NOAA CO-OPS (COD0904 Canal RR-bridge, COD0911 Woods Hole) · wind Open-Meteo · ~1 day lead, re-check race morning.

Route — Boston → Cape Cod Canal → Marion → Woods Hole → Edgartown



⚡ Current gates — get these right

Gate	Day	Timing (EDT)	Notes / cautions
CAPE COD CANAL (westbound → ride the EBB)	Tue 07-21	EBB sets WSW 248° toward Buzzards Bay = FAIR. Fair: 04:00–09:50 (too early) & 16:20–22:20 (max ebb 18:53, −4.2 kt).	AVOID max FLOOD 13:51 (+3.8 kt, nose). Motor only (no sailing); Canal Control VHF 13; obey signal lights; 10 mph limit.
WOODS HOLE (transit at SLACK)	Wed 07-22	SLACK 05:38 · 11:42 · 18:04. Target 11:42 — through in 20–30 min.	Set (NOAA): flood 077°/ENE · ebb 261°/WSW — cross-check Eldridge + local knowledge. Rocks + eddies; bail to Quicks Hole in 20+ kt.

Leg-by-leg timing (from 08:00 start, ~6 kt)

LEG 1 · Tue 07-21 · Boston → Marion · ~55 nm (via the Canal)

08:00 depart Boston; motor-sail SE across Mass/Cape Cod Bay. ~15:00 reach the Canal E entrance (Sandwich) — the canal is FLOODING against you (easing). DECISION: (A) ease to ~5.5 kt / hold off Sandwich to the 16:20 slack, then ride the building WSW ebb (up to +4 kt) — through by ~17:00; or (B) push on at ~15:00 and punch the easing flood (~2–2.5 kt, SOG ~3.5 kt), slack mid-canal ~16:20, ebb helps the 2nd half — through by ~16:15. Exit W end ~16:30 → ~9 nm up Buzzards Bay → Marion ~18:00–18:30 (sunset 20:10, daylight).

LEG 2 · Wed 07-22 · Marion → Edgartown · ~22 nm (via Woods Hole)

Target the 11:42 Woods Hole slack. Depart Marion ~09:40; ~11 nm down Buzzards Bay (building downwind SW chop). ~11:40 Woods Hole — transit AT slack, through in 20–30 min. ~12:10 into Vineyard Sound → ~11 nm → Edgartown ~14:00 (daylight). ⚠ WIND: Wed builds a strong SW sea-breeze (15–20 kt, GUSTS 26–35 in Buzzards Bay) through the afternoon — REEF before leaving Marion; the morning schedule front-loads the leg before the worst.

Weather, Hazards & Full Current Tables

Eagle · Boston → Marion → Edgartown · 2026-07-21/22

Wind & visibility (Open-Meteo, kt)

When	Mass/Cape Cod Bay	Buzzards Bay	Vineyard Sound	Fog / visibility
Tue 07-21 AM (Leg 1)	S/SE 8-10	S 8-10	—	good (13-18 km)
Tue 07-21 PM	SE 12-15 G18-23	S ~9	—	good
Wed 07-22 (Leg 2)	—	S/SW 15-20 G26-35	S 14-16 G30	good (13-22 km)

FOG: none in the NWS forecast for either day (zones ANZ235/236/237 clean; vis 12-22 km) — good news for Woods Hole. Still July: recheck each morning.

Hazards & procedures

• Cape Cod Canal

Motor ONLY (sailing prohibited). Monitor Canal Control VHF 13; obey the traffic-signal lights at each end; 10 mph (≈8.7 kt over ground) limit. Land cut ~7 nm; strong wakes from traffic. Ride the ebb (§ page 1).

• Woods Hole

Transit at/near SLACK (11:42 Wed) only — rock-strewn, strong cross-set + eddies, heavy ferry traffic. Follow the marked channel (green-to-starboard inbound to Buzzards Bay = reverse for us). Cross-check Eldridge current diagram. Bail-out: Quicks Hole (wider, far less current) or wait for the next slack.

• Wednesday SW blow

Buzzards Bay's afternoon 'smoky sou'wester' builds to 15-20 G26-35. Reef at the dock in Marion; the Marion→Woods Hole run is a building downwind chop. If Woods Hole/Vineyard Sound look bad in 20+ kt, delay or use Quicks Hole.

• Daylight

Sunrise ~05:26 / sunset ~20:10 both days. Every transit (Canal ~16:30, Marion arr ~18:00, Woods Hole 11:42, Edgartown ~14:00) is in daylight — no night pilotage required if on schedule.

• Dual-handed

Long Leg-1 day (~10 h). Set watches, autopilot, jacklines/tethers for the open-water legs; pre-stage the canal + Woods Hole waypoints and current times before departure.

Full current predictions (NOAA CO-OPS, EDT)

CAPE COD CANAL (COD0904, RR bridge) — flood 66°→Cape Cod Bay / ebb 248°→Buzzards Bay

Tue 07-21: 01:27 flood +3.6 · 03:52 SLACK · 06:17 EBB -4.1 · 09:53 SLACK · 13:51 flood +3.8 · 16:20 SLACK · 18:53 EBB -4.2 (westbound wants the EBB → the 16:20-22:20 window is your gate.)

WOODS HOLE (COD0911, The Strait) — flood 077° / ebb 261°; max ~2.4-3.2 kt

Wed 07-22: 03:28 flood +2.9 · 05:38 SLACK · 07:36 ebb -2.4 · 11:42 SLACK · 15:50 flood +3.0 · 18:04 SLACK · 21:49 ebb -2.5 (transit at the 11:42 SLACK.)



Rain & convection risk (HRRR vs HRDPS)

RAIN — Tue (Leg 1) DRY (~0 mm, both models). Wed (Leg 2) WET, showers likely: HRRR light rain (53-88% prob), HRDPS heavier showers (15-46 mm over Buzzards Bay / Vineyard Sound). Carry foulies; reduced viz in showers.
THUNDER — Tue low (CAPE 0-170). Wed MODERATE / possible (CAPE 400-850 + a showery front): scattered afternoon cells; HRRR gusts to ~38 kt = squall gust-fronts. A storm at Woods Hole / in Vineyard Sound is a real hazard.
→ Reinforces the plan: cross EARLY (Woods Hole 11:42 slack → Edgartown ~14:00) before the afternoon convection.
Wed AM, check for firing cells — delay or use the Quicks Hole bail-out if storms are up.